

21 August 2026

Letter of Work Experience — Lydia Fikire Shirga, Junior Programmer

To Whom It May Concern,

I am pleased to confirm the work of **Lydia Fikire Shirga** with my team at Development Gateway: An IREX Venture.

Lydia served as a **Junior Programmer** on our **Ministry of Agriculture ICT (MOA-ICT) team** from **5 June 2025 to 30 June 2026**, approximately thirteen months. Her initial engagement was extended part-way through on the strength of her work.

Her role supported the **aLIVE program** (*a Livestock Information Vision Ethiopia*), a Gates Foundation-funded initiative delivered with Ethiopia's Ministry of Agriculture and the Livestock Improvement Corporation to build a national livestock data standard and information system.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Supporting development and maintenance of the aLIVE data systems
- Coding, testing, and technical documentation
- Working with program staff and Ministry counterparts to troubleshoot platform issues

Lydia was capable, reliable, and quick to learn, and worked well with both our team and our Ministry counterparts. She completed her engagement in good standing.

I am glad to recommend her for a master's program scholarship, and would be happy to answer any questions about her work with us.

Sincerely,



Fernando Ferreyra
Director of Software Development
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